# RankYak — Feature Specification

A structured feature inventory for building a comparable SEO automation platform

**Research date:** 2 October 2026
**Source:** RankYak public website and Help Center
**Purpose:** Product planning, architecture, feature scoping, and development estimation

> **Important:** This document describes publicly observable/product-documented functionality. It is not a claim about RankYak's private implementation, algorithms, proprietary data sources, or internal infrastructure.

## Executive summary

RankYak is positioned as an end-to-end SEO automation platform. Its workflow starts with website/niche analysis and keyword discovery, turns approved opportunities into a content calendar, researches and generates articles, publishes them to connected websites, monitors existing pages, refreshes content, and builds backlinks. An in-app Copilot and external MCP server allow users to operate many of these functions through natural-language AI commands.

# 1. Product architecture at a glance

The product can be thought of as eight major systems:

- **Discovery:** website analysis, keyword research, keyword scoring, topical map, clusters.
- **Planning:** monthly content plan, calendar, publishing cadence, automation.
- **Content:** SERP/competitor research, search intent, article generation, editing, metadata, links, media.
- **Publishing:** CMS integrations, drafts, automatic publishing, republishing, API/RSS/webhooks.
- **Optimization:** Site Guard, CTR checks, title/meta fixes, cannibalization, article refreshes.
- **Authority:** backlink exchange and backlink monitoring.
- **AI control:** Copilot and external MCP server.
- **Platform layer:** sites, organizations, team members, billing, usage/fair-use controls.

# 2. Keyword Discovery & Research

RankYak analyzes a website/niche and continually discovers search opportunities. Keywords are evaluated against both demand and the site's ability to compete.

- Website/niche scanning to understand the business and subject area.
- Core topics that anchor the site's topical map.
- Keyword clusters grouping closely related searches under a primary keyword.
- Keyword scoring using search volume, difficulty, and site authority.
- Monthly re-scoring as site authority changes.
- Emerging/rising keyword discovery.
- Research runs that can be reviewed before keywords enter the active pool.
- Approve/reject workflow for research results.
- Optional automatic approval/autopilot research.
- Manual keyword entry in addition to discovered keywords.
- Google Search Console connection so real impression/query data influences research.
- Coverage view showing published, planned, and open topic/cluster opportunities.
- Avoidance of keyword cannibalization by grouping searches that produce similar results.

# 3. Topical Map & Authority Strategy

The topical map is the organizing layer between keyword research and content production.

- Core topics → keyword clusters → individual keywords.
- Coverage tracking for what is published, planned, or still missing.
- Cluster-based content strategy instead of treating every keyword as a separate article.
- Internal linking between related articles to strengthen topical coverage.
- Identification of opportunities as the site's authority increases.
- Money-page relationship: informational content can support commercial/product/service pages.

# 4. Content Plan & Calendar

Approved keywords flow into a monthly content plan. The calendar determines what gets written and when.

- Automatic monthly content-plan generation.
- Opportunity prioritization based on search volume versus difficulty.
- Daily/selected-day publishing schedule.
- Drag/reschedule planned articles.
- Swap the keyword assigned to a calendar slot.
- Remove a planned article.
- Move an article to an earlier date.
- Batch publishing/launch-week scheduling.
- Quiet days or custom publishing cadence.
- Full autopilot mode that fills the calendar and publishes according to settings.
- Schedule controls including time of day and timezone.

# 5. AI Article Generation

Articles are generated only after research of the target keyword and current ranking pages.

- SERP/top-ranking-page analysis before writing.
- Search-intent identification.
- Article-type selection such as listicle, how-to, or expanded definition.
- Target-length calculation based on ranking content.
- Related questions and searches incorporated where relevant.
- Structured headings, lists, and tables where appropriate.
- Internal links to existing site pages and money pages.
- External references/citations to reputable sources.
- SEO title, meta title, meta description, and clean URL slug.
- Header image plus optional in-article images/infographics.
- Relevant YouTube embeds.
- Brand voice and site audience settings.
- 40+ supported writing languages.
- Live generation progress/streaming in the article interface.
- Article revisions and editing.
- Article refreshes using new research while keeping the same URL/history.
- Draft-before-publish option or automatic publication.

# 6. Media & Visual Content

- Generated header images.
- Optional in-article images.
- Infographic generation/support.
- Relevant YouTube video embeds.
- Site image library from which article imagery can be selected.
- Ability for Copilot/MCP actions to generate a new header image or select existing site imagery.

# 7. Publishing & CMS Integrations

RankYak can publish directly to supported platforms or use generic integration methods for other sites.

- WordPress.
- WordPress.com.
- Shopify.
- Wix.
- Webflow.
- Duda.
- Ghost.
- Lovable-built sites.
- Replit-built sites.
- Next.js sites.
- Make.
- Zapier.
- REST API.
- RSS feed.
- Webhooks.
- Automatic publishing or draft-only workflow.
- One-click/manual publishing.
- Republish/push edited articles after changes.
- Publishing status and publishing-error handling.
- Manual copy/paste fallback when no integration is connected.

# 8. Google Search Console & Performance Data

- Connect a Google Search Console property to the site.
- Read search impressions and clicks.
- Use existing search queries to guide keyword research.
- Identify rising queries as potential new content opportunities.
- Identify underperforming content as refresh candidates.
- Compare page performance with expected click-through performance by ranking position.
- Use actual search performance to steer ongoing SEO decisions.

# 9. Site Guard / Existing-Site Optimization

Site Guard focuses on pages that already exist rather than only generating new content.

- Periodic crawling/auditing of selected pages.
- Weak/short title detection.
- Meta-description issues.
- Click-through-rate opportunity detection.
- Suggested title and meta-description fixes.

- Review-before-apply workflow.
- Re-crawling to verify whether an issue was resolved.
- Daily checking against Search Console performance data.
- Page-level optimization workflow.
- Article refreshes when rankings/performance decline.
- Search cannibalization detection.
- Identify competing pages for the same search.
- Choose a winning page and prepare redirect/consolidation recommendations.

# 10. Money Pages

RankYak includes a dedicated concept for important commercial pages that should receive support from informational content.

- Create, update, and delete money pages.
- Accept or dismiss money-page suggestions.
- Use internal links from supporting articles to important commercial pages.
- Use money-page relationships when planning content clusters.

# 11. Backlink Exchange

- Automated backlink exchange between participating websites.
- Matching with relevant websites in the network.
- Contextual placement inside articles.
- Backlink overview/dashboard.
- No manual outreach workflow required.
- Links accumulate over time rather than relying on a single campaign.
- Backlink counts are available to the Copilot/MCP layer.

# 12. AI Copilot

The Copilot is an account-aware assistant that can read project data and perform supported actions.

- Natural-language commands.
- Read keywords, clusters, calendar, articles, audits, and performance data.
- Add keywords.
- Plan or reschedule content.
- Swap or remove planned articles.
- Regenerate content plans.
- Read article research and SEO analysis.
- Edit article title, text, meta title, and meta description.
- Generate/select article images.
- Publish articles or push edits.
- Manage Site Guard findings and fixes.
- Manage money pages.

- Update site settings and automation toggles.
- Answer questions using the user's own project/account data.
- Inline edit proposals are available inside the native Copilot experience.

# 13. MCP Server / External AI Control

RankYak exposes an MCP server so compatible AI clients can operate the account without using the RankYak UI.

- Remote MCP endpoint for MCP-capable assistants.
- Connect tools such as Claude and Cursor.
- Account authorization flow.
- Read/manage sites and settings.
- Manage keywords and topic clusters.
- Run/review keyword research.
- Manage content-plan dates.
- Read/edit articles and SEO analysis.
- Publish articles and push edits.
- Manage Site Guard.
- Manage money pages.
- Manage integrations.
- Read Search Console performance.
- Organization/member visibility and management.
- Search/read RankYak's help center.
- Uses the same underlying controls/checks as the product's Copilot for supported actions.

# 14. Organizations, Sites & Team Management

- Multiple websites under one subscription depending on plan.
- Each site keeps separate keywords, content plan, and articles.
- Switch between sites from a central dashboard.
- Organizations/workspaces.
- Team members and invitations.
- Organization settings.
- Per-site capabilities/usage visibility.
- Agency-oriented multi-client management.

# 15. Agency / Multi-Client Model

- Central dashboard for client sites.
- Business-tier support for multiple/unlimited sites subject to fair-use rules.
- Separate SEO assets and content plans per site.
- Useful foundation for an agency/reseller product model.

# 16. Account, Billing & Usage

- Subscription plans.
- Monthly or annual billing.
- Article allowances/credits.
- Audited-page allowances.
- Page-fix allowances.
- Cannibalization-audit allowances on eligible plans.
- Extra article credits.
- Fair-use controls for high-volume/multi-site usage.
- Site-level feature/usage visibility.

# 17. Free SEO Tools / Lead-Generation Layer

The public product site also exposes standalone SEO tools that can support acquisition and product-led growth.

- Robots.txt Tester.
- Redirect Checker.
- Meta Tag Checker.
- Broken Link Checker.
- Keyword Clustering.
- Schema Generator.
- Additional free tools available through the site's tools area.

# 18. Solutions / Product Positioning

- General SEO automation.
- Agency/client SEO.
- SaaS SEO.
- E-commerce SEO.
- Startup SEO.
- Local-business SEO.
- Search visibility for Google and AI-answer ecosystems.

# 19. Suggested Feature Architecture for Your Build

If the goal is to build a comparable product rather than reproduce RankYak's UI, the cleanest architecture is to split the platform into modules:

| Module | Core responsibility |
|---|---|
| Organizations & Sites | Multi-tenant accounts, workspaces, domains, settings, team access. |
| Crawler | Fetch site pages, extract metadata/content/links, build site inventory. |
| Search Data | Search-volume/difficulty data, SERP data, Search Console data. |
| Keyword Engine | Discovery, scoring, clustering, topic mapping, approval workflow. |
| Strategy Engine | Opportunity scoring, topical coverage, content recommendations, money pages. |
| Content Planner | Calendar, cadence, keyword-to-article assignment, scheduling. |

| Module | Core responsibility |
|---|---|
| AI Research | SERP analysis, intent, competitor structure, questions, target length. |
| AI Writer | Article generation, brand voice, multilingual content, citations, metadata. |
| Media Engine | Images, infographics, YouTube embeds, media library. |
| SEO Optimizer | Internal links, metadata, refreshes, cannibalization, content scoring. |
| Site Guard | Audits, CTR opportunities, title/meta fixes, verification. |
| Publishing Engine | WordPress/CMS connectors, API, RSS, webhooks, drafts, republishing. |
| Backlink Engine | Partner network, matching, placement, tracking. |
| AI Copilot | Natural-language account operations. |
| MCP/API | External AI and developer automation. |
| Billing & Usage | Plans, credits, limits, add-ons, fair-use controls. |
| Agency Layer | Multi-site client management and team permissions. |

# 20. Important External Dependencies to Plan For

Some RankYak capabilities depend on external data or platform integrations. If you build a similar system, these dependencies should be treated as first-class architecture decisions.

- Search-volume/keyword data provider.
- SERP/search-result data provider.
- Google Search Console OAuth/API.
- LLM provider(s) for research, writing, editing, and Copilot.
- Image-generation provider.
- YouTube data/embed support.
- CMS APIs and OAuth credentials.
- Backlink partner/network inventory.
- Crawler/browser infrastructure.
- Queue/job system for recurring research, writing, crawling, and publishing.
- Usage metering and subscription billing.

# 21. Recommended MVP Scope

For a first release, you do not need to implement every RankYak capability. A practical MVP would be:

- Multi-tenant organizations + websites.
- Website crawler.
- Keyword discovery/import.
- Keyword scoring and clustering.
- Topical map.
- Google Search Console integration.
- Content calendar.
- AI article research + generation.
- Brand voice/site settings.

- Metadata, internal links, citations, and images.
- WordPress integration first.
- Draft or automatic publishing.
- Basic article editor + revisions.
- Basic Site Guard for titles/meta descriptions.
- Natural-language Copilot for the MVP's own actions.
- Subscription/usage limits.

# 22. Features to Add After MVP

- Shopify/Wix/Webflow/Ghost/Duda connectors.
- Make/Zapier/API/RSS/webhooks.
- Cannibalization analysis and redirects.
- Article refresh automation.
- Money pages.
- Backlink exchange/network.
- MCP server.
- Advanced agency controls.
- Advanced media/infographic generation.
- Broader AI-search visibility analytics.
- Free SEO tools for acquisition.

# Sources & verification

The feature inventory was compiled from RankYak's public site and current Help Center pages accessed on 2 October 2026. The most detailed sources used were:

- RankYak home/product overview — https://rankyak.com/
- Feature overview — https://rankyak.com/help/feature-overview
- Keyword research — https://rankyak.com/features/keyword-research
- Article generation — https://rankyak.com/help/article-generation
- Content plan — https://rankyak.com/help/content-plan
- Publishing articles — https://rankyak.com/help/publishing-articles
- MCP server — https://rankyak.com/help/mcp
- Help Center — https://rankyak.com/help

> Note: Features, pricing, integrations, and limits can change. This document is a snapshot of the publicly documented product at the research date.